



MMAKO INC.

Brand Guidelines

Mmako Inc. · Version 1.3 · September 2026

Brand overview

Mmako Inc. is a South African business law firm built for the pace at which modern business actually operates. The firm works with founders, growing companies, established businesses and individuals in disputes, across corporate advisory, commercial contracts, dispute resolution and ongoing legal support.

The brand exists to close a specific gap: legal counsel that is genuinely useful to a commercial decision-maker. Not counsel buried in jargon, not counsel billed by the hour regardless of outcome, and not counsel that takes days to reach. Every expression of the brand — from a letter of demand to a social post — should leave the reader knowing exactly where they stand and what happens next.

The naming rule

The firm is ****Mmako Inc.**** everywhere — in the logo and in writing. Page titles, email signatures, letterheads, invoices, legal documents and social posts all use Mmako Inc.

****Mmako Incorporated**** is the full legal entity. Use it in copyright lines, contractual documents and the email confidentiality notice, and nowhere else.

The logo's wordmark reads MMAKO INC. in capitals. That is artwork, not type: it appears only as the supplied logo files and is never retyped, reset in a font, or written in capitals in running text.

The firm has previously been referred to as "Mmako Law". That name is retired. It should not appear in any new asset, document or post.

Settled. The revised artwork's wordmark reads MMAKO INC., so the mark and the written name agree. The earlier "Mmako Law" wordmark is retired and should not appear in any new asset.

Personality

Four traits. Each is written as a pair, because a trait without its limit becomes a caricature.

Direct

Is: Says the thing plainly, including when the answer is unwelcome. Leads with the conclusion.

Is not: Blunt for its own sake, or dismissive of a client's concern.

Commercial

Is: Weighs every recommendation against what it means for the business, not just the legal technicality.

Is not: Cavalier about legal risk, or willing to trade away a client's position for speed.

Responsive

Is: Moves at the client's pace. Acknowledges quickly, and says when a full answer will land.

Is not: Reactive or rushed — speed never comes at the cost of getting it right.

Assured

Is: Confident in its own judgment. Comfortable making a recommendation rather than listing options.

Is not: Boastful. The brand never claims accolades, rankings or credentials it has not earned.

Values

Clarity — *Plain language first.*

We explain what matters in terms the client can act on. If a sentence needs a legal dictionary, it gets rewritten.

Commercial judgment — *Advice weighed against the business.*

Every recommendation is measured against what it means commercially, not only what the law permits.

Advocacy — *Representation that holds up.*

When a matter turns adversarial, we push hard for a fair outcome and say so plainly from the outset.

Access — *Real access to your lawyer.*

Clients should not wait days for an update. Reachability is a service standard, not a courtesy.

Positioning

For founders, growing companies and individuals who need legal support that keeps pace with their business, Mmako Inc. is a modern South African business law firm that gives clear, fast, outcome-focused counsel. Unlike traditional firms that bill by the hour and communicate in legalese, Mmako Inc. is paid for solving the problem and explains everything in plain English.

What the brand does not claim

No rankings, awards, accolades, firm size or years of experience. If the firm earns those they can be added — until then no asset should imply them.

Tone of voice

1. Lead with the answer.

Put the conclusion in the first sentence, then the reasoning. A client reading on their phone should get the answer before they scroll.

2. Write the way you would explain it out loud.

If you would not say it to the client across a desk, do not write it.

3. Prefer the short word.

Use, not utilise. Start, not commence. About, not in relation to.

4. Be specific about what happens next.

Every piece of client communication ends with a concrete next step and, where relevant, a date.

5. Never oversell.

No rankings, awards, superlatives or claims the firm cannot substantiate. Confidence comes from precision, not adjectives.

Rewrites

We are pleased to advise that we have given consideration to the aforementioned matter and are of the view that there may potentially be merit in pursuing the matter further.

You have a strong claim. We recommend sending a letter of demand this week.

Kindly note that same shall be attended to in due course.

We will have this back to you by Thursday.

Vocabulary

Use: clear, practical, commercial, straightforward, outcome, plainly, where you stand

Avoid: bespoke solutions, leverage, synergy, world-class, premier, cutting-edge, kindly note, aforementioned, herewith

The logo

The primary logo is the stacked lockup: monogram, wordmark, gold rule.



Primary — on light



Primary — reversed

Clear space

Keep clear space around the logo equal to the height of the monogram's bottom serif on all sides. Nothing — type, image edge or rule — enters that space.

Minimum size

- Full lockup: 24mm wide in print, 120px on screen. Below that the wordmark stops reading.
- Monogram alone: 8mm in print, 32px on screen.

Which version to use

- **Primary (stacked)** — covers, letterhead, folders, signage, anywhere with vertical room.
- **Secondary (horizontal)** — website header and any band under 60px tall.
- **Monogram** — favicon, social avatar, email signature, stamps and small marks.
- **Black / White** — single-colour print, embroidery, etching, faxes, newspaper.

Logo misuse

Each of these breaks the mark. None of them is acceptable, in any medium.

Do not stretch, squash or otherwise change the proportions.

Do not recolour the mark. Gold and ink are fixed; the only alternatives are the supplied all-black and all-white versions.

Do not retype the wordmark. MMAKO INC. appears only as the supplied artwork, never reset in a font.

Do not add effects — shadows, glows, bevels, outlines or gradients.

Do not rotate the logo or set it on an angle.

Do not place the colour logo on a mid-tone background or a busy photograph. Use the reversed version on dark, and the dark version on light.

Do not box the logo, or lock it up with another mark without clear space between them.

Do not use the monogram and the full lockup together in the same composition.

Primary palette

Three colours carry the brand. Everything else supports them.



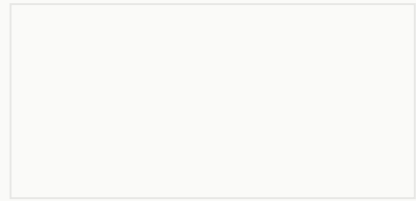
Mmako Ink

#0B0B0C
RGB 11, 11, 12
CMYK 8 / 8 / 0 / 95



Mmako Gold

#BB9B66
RGB 187, 155, 102
CMYK 0 / 17 / 45 / 27



Bone

#FAFAF8
RGB 250, 250, 248
CMYK 0 / 0 / 1 / 2

Secondary palette



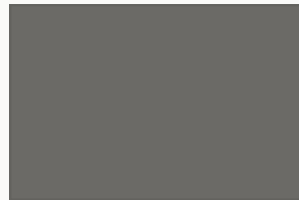
Gold Deep

#85693B
RGB 133, 105, 59
CMYK 0 / 21 / 56 / 48



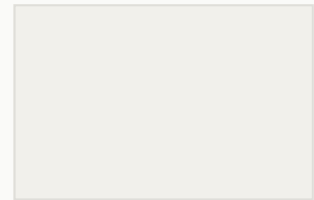
Gold Bright

#D2BC96
RGB 210, 188, 150
CMYK 0 / 10 / 29 / 18



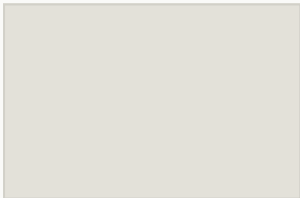
Warm Grey

#6B6A66
RGB 107, 106, 102
CMYK 0 / 1 / 5 / 58



Bone 200

#F1F0EB
RGB 241, 240, 235
CMYK 0 / 0 / 2 / 5



Bone 300

#E3E1D9
RGB 227, 225, 217
CMYK 0 / 1 / 4 / 11



Ink 800

#17171A
RGB 23, 23, 26
CMYK 12 / 12 / 0 / 90

Gold is an accent, never a field. It appears as thin rules, underlines, icon accents, button fills and hover states. Flooded across a large area it stops reading as premium.

Colour in use

Contrast

Mmako Gold on Bone reaches only **2.51:1** — below the 4.5:1 WCAG AA minimum. It must never be used for text on a light ground. Use Gold Deep instead, which reaches **4.92:1**. On dark grounds Mmako Gold is fine, at **7.49:1**.

COLOUR	ON BONE	ON INK	SAFE AS TEXT ON
Mmako Ink	18.83:1 AA	1.00:1 —	Bone
Mmako Gold	2.51:1 —	7.49:1 AA	Ink
Bone	1.00:1 —	18.83:1 AA	Ink
Gold Deep	4.92:1 AA	3.82:1 large only	Bone, Ink (large)
Gold Bright	1.77:1 —	10.66:1 AA	Ink
Warm Grey	5.18:1 AA	3.63:1 large only	Bone, Ink (large)
Bone 200	1.09:1 —	17.24:1 AA	Ink
Bone 300	1.25:1 —	15.03:1 AA	Ink
Ink 800	17.12:1 AA	1.10:1 —	Bone

AA = passes 4.5:1 for body text. "large only" = passes 3:1, so 24px / 18pt and above. "—" = not usable as text on that ground.

Print

Mmako Ink — For solid areas use a rich black build — C60 M50 Y40 K100. For text under 18pt use K100 only, to avoid registration fringing.

Mmako Gold — Read directly out of the supplied logo file, so it is the identity's true gold. Confirm against a printed draw-down — muted golds shift noticeably on uncoated stock.

Bone — Do not print. Use the unprinted stock, or match to a warm white paper.

CMYK values are arithmetic, not colour-managed. They will shift between coated and uncoated stock. Ask the printer for a draw-down of Mmako Gold on the actual stock and approve against that, not a screen. No Pantone references are specified — supplying a guessed PMS number would be worse than supplying none.

Typography

One family carries the whole system. Montserrat is the geometric sans the logo's own wordmark is set in, so the type and the mark read as one thing.

Aa

Weight 600 — headings

Tracking tightened, -0.025em at display size easing to -0.01em by H4. Montserrat is drawn loose; headings look gappy untracked.

Aa

Weight 400 — body

1.75 line-height on screen. The face is wide with a modest x-height, so it needs more leading than a neo-grotesque.

Geometric sans, variable, with italics · SIL Open Font License 1.1 — free for commercial use, embeddable

Hierarchy

LEVEL	WEIGHT	SCREEN	PRINT	TRACKING	USE
Display	600	64px / 1.12	32pt / 36pt	-0.025em	Homepage hero only
H1	600	52px / 1.18	26pt / 31pt	-0.025em	Page titles
H2	600	44px / 1.15	22pt / 26pt	-0.02em	Section headings
H3	600	28px / 1.3	14pt / 18pt	-0.02em	Service and article titles
H4	600	18px / 1.45	11pt / 16pt	-0.01em	Card titles
Body Large	400	18px / 1.75	11pt / 17pt	0	Intros, standfirsts
Body	400	16px / 1.75	10pt / 16pt	0	Default reading size
Small	400	14px / 1.65	9pt / 14pt	0	Captions, table cells, footnotes
Eyebrow	500	12px / 1.4	7.5pt / 11pt	0.2em	Uppercase section labels above headings

There is no second family. The identity already carries contrast between the monogram's Didone serif and the wordmark's geometric sans — a third voice in the running text would muddy it. Weight, size and tracking do the work a second family would otherwise do.

Word and Outlook cannot load webfonts. Montserrat is free, so install it on every machine in the firm and documents match the brand exactly. Without it the supplied templates fall back through Montserrat, 'Century Gothic', Arial, sans-serif — Century Gothic ships with Office on Windows and Mac; Arial is on everything.

Visual system

The system is deliberately small. Four elements carry it.

1. The gold hairline

A 1-2px gold rule, 28-40px long, above a section heading or beneath a logo. The most-used device and the most restrained.



2. The diagonal

The angled stroke from the monogram's gold accent, used sparingly as a large background element at low opacity. Never decoration on top of content.

3. The dark surface

Near-black with two soft gold radial glows and a faint 72px grid. This is what gives dark sections depth without photography.

4. Generous whitespace

Space is an element, not leftover room. 80-128px vertical padding on screen, 20-26mm in print.

Iconography

Line only, 1.25px stroke on a 24×24 grid, round caps and joins, geometric construction. Icons inherit the surrounding text colour. Never filled, duotone or cartoon.

Never

Drop shadows, decorative gradients, corner radii above 2px, stock illustration, gavels, scales of justice, columns, or any other legal cliché.

Photography

The firm has no photography yet. Until it does, the brand deliberately uses none rather than stock — the abstract gold-line figure and dark surface stand in.

Direction, when commissioned

- **Natural light.** Available light, no hard flash, no studio gloss.
- **Architectural and environmental.** The office, the city, working surfaces. People at work rather than posed.
- **Muted and warm.** Desaturated, warm-neutral grade that sits with bone and near-black. Gold may appear in the scene but is never added in post.
- **Unposed.** Mid-conversation, mid-work. No folded arms, no handshakes.
- **Room to breathe.** Compose with negative space so type can sit over the image.

Never

Gavels, scales of justice, law libraries, stock handshakes, or any image that could appear on a competitor's site.

Layout

- **Screen:** 12 columns, 1152px max content width, 20–32px gutters.
- **Print:** single column, 20mm margins, 170mm live text width.
- **Asymmetric by default.** Headings left in 4–5 columns, content in the rest.
- **Dark/light rhythm.** Never two dark sections adjacent.
- **Spacing:** multiples of 4px — 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 80, 96, 128.

Applications

Every item below is supplied as a finished file in the kit. Anything the firm types into is supplied as an editable Word document; anything a printer produces is supplied as a print-ready PDF.

Stationery

ITEM	SIZE	FORMAT
Letterhead	A4 — 210 × 297 mm	Word (.docx) + PDF + PNG preview
Document template	A4, with page numbers and heading styles	Word (.docx)
Business card	90 × 50 mm trim, 96 × 56 mm with bleed	PDF, front and back
Envelope	DL — 220 × 110 mm	PDF
Compliment slip	210 × 99 mm	PDF
Email signature	560 px wide	HTML + plain text, two variants

Legal documents

ITEM	FORMAT
Legal letter template	Word (.docx) + A4 PDF + PNG preview
Legal opinion template	Word (.docx) + A4 PDF + PNG preview
Invoice	Word (.docx) + A4 PDF + PNG preview
Proposal / quotation	Word (.docx) + A4 PDF + PNG preview

Digital

ITEM	SIZE
LinkedIn banner	1584 × 396 px
LinkedIn profile image	400 × 400 px
Social — quote card	1080 × 1080 px
Social — announcement	1080 × 1080 px
Social — portrait	1080 × 1350 px
Email header	600 × 180 px

Before this goes to print

Two things must be settled. Each affects finished artwork.

Settled since version 1.2. The firm supplied revised artwork whose wordmark reads **MMAKO INC.** — so the mark and the written name now agree and the naming question is closed. The palette takes its gold straight from that artwork (**#BB9B66**), with Gold Deep and Gold Bright re-derived from it at the same hue.

1. Company details are placeholders

Registration number, VAT number and banking details appear as bracketed placeholders on the letterhead, invoice and legal templates. Supply them before anything is printed or issued.

2. The confidentiality notice needs sign-off

The wording in the email signature is a reasonable general form. It has not been reviewed against the firm's professional-indemnity or Legal Practice Council obligations.

This document is version 1.3. Once the two items above are closed, reissue it as version 1.4 and circulate that as the governing version.